COLORADO
Department of Early Childhood

AGGREGATE DATA ON SERIOUS INJURIES, DEATHS, AND SUBSTANTIATED CASES OF CHILD ABUSE THAT HAVE OCCURRED IN CHILD CARE SETTINGS

LICENSED CAPACITY AND INJURIES IN CHILD CARE SETTINGS

Licensed capacity is the point-in-time maximum number of children a provider can legally care for according to their license type. Table 1 shows how many providers had an open license in each license type and what the total aggregate licensed capacity was for each type at the end of Federal Fiscal Year 2024 (September 30, 2024). In addition to licensed providers, legally qualified exempt providers (non-relative only) are also reported.

Licensed child care providers are required by law to complete an Online Injury Report within 24 hours of any injury in which a child received emergency medical attention or has been hospitalized. In Federal Fiscal Year 2024 (October 1, 2023 through September 30, 2024), **1,597 injuries requiring medical attention or hospitalization were reported** (may or may not have been related to licensing violations) by licensed and legally qualified exempt child care providers in Colorado.

Table 1. Provider Count, Licensed Capacity, and Injuries by Provider Type

Provider Type	Total Provider Count	Licensed Capacity	Number of Injuries	Percentage of Injuries	Status of Provider Reporting the Injury		
					Open	Closed	Pending
Center	1674	135807	1179	.86%	1113	48	18
Home	1282	11060	33	.29%	32	1	0
Preschool	506	19031	76	.39%	76	0	0
School-Age	966	81795	309	.37%	293	13	3
Legally Qualified Exempt, non-relative	109	N/A	0	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

**Licensed care providers are less than 24-hour programs with varying care based on age and number of children. Home types include family child care home, experienced family child care home, infant/toddler home, large family child care home, and three under two family child care home. Qualified exempt, non-relative are legally licensed exempt providers that accept Colorado Child Care Assistance Program funding.*

***Injuries are self-reported by providers, and may not be reflective of all injuries not reported.*

FATALITIES IN CHILD CARE SETTINGS

For purposes of this report, the number of fatalities reported is based on the Colorado Department of Early Childhood child care licensing data, which is more up to date than but not as comprehensive as the Colorado Child Fatality Prevention System (CFPS). The table below displays the number of child fatalities of any cause (n=0) in Federal Fiscal Year 2024 (October 1, 2023 through September 30, 2024).

Table 2. Number of Fatalities by Provider Type in Federal Fiscal Year 2024

Provider Type*	Number of Fatalities
Center	0
Home	0
Preschool	0
School-Age	0
Legally Qualified Exempt, non-relative	N/A

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SUBSTANTIATED CASES OF ABUSE AND/OR NEGLECT IN CHILD CARE SETTINGS

Colorado law defines child abuse and/or neglect in Section 19-1-13 of the Colorado Revised Statutes. The table below displays the number of cases of abuse and/or neglect that occurred in Licensed or Legally Qualified Exempt child care providers (non-relative only) and were founded, or substantiated, after investigation (n= 170) in Federal Fiscal Year 2024 (October 1, 2023 through September 30, 2024).

Table 3. Number of Substantiated Cases of Abuse and Neglect by Provider Type in Federal Fiscal Year 2024

Provider Type*	Number of Substantiated Cases
Center	142
Home	14
Preschool	6
School-Age	8
Legally Qualified Exempt, Non-relative	0

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